NICOL LEÓN ARGE

LOCAL NEWS REPORTER

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Portfolio

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Bilingual journalist with experience in local newsrooms across New York, New Jersey, Arizona and Washington state. My reporting focuses on how government decisions and public policies affect everyday life, particularly in Latino and immigrant communities. As a native Spanish speaker, I bring a cross-cultural perspective to reporting on communities often overlooked in local news coverage.

TECHNICAL AND REPORTING SKILLS

Local Reporting: City government, breaking news, public records, source development, field interviews, fact-checking.
Bilingual Reporting: Spanish-language interviews, community sourcing, reporting in English and Spanish.
Data & Multimedia: Datawrapper, Excel, Adobe Premiere Pro, CapCut, Photoshop.

EDUCATION

Craig Newmark Graduate School of Journalism at CUNY, New York, NY
M.A. Bilingual Journalism, Data Journalism Specialization, 2025

Universidad Nacional Federico Villarreal, Lima, Peru
B.A. Communication Sciences, Journalism Specialization, 2018

RECOGNITION

Newsweek Alumni Prize - 2026 Alumni Awards for Excellence
NAHJ-FIU Chapter, Second Place, 2025
Lorana Sullivan Scholar, CUNY, 2024

JOURNALISM EXPERIENCE

The New York Times (New York, NY)

Stringer | Feb 2026 – Present

- Reported from the scene of the deadly Staten Island shipyard explosions, interviewing eyewitnesses in English and Spanish for breaking news coverage.
- Interviewed commuters in English and Spanish at Hoboken Terminal about NJ Transit service disruptions during the Portal North Bridge cutover, gathering firsthand accounts for a Sunday preview story, live updates and a follow-up article summarizing the day's disruptions.
- Shot original video footage for The Times' vertical social media coverage.

Tri-City Herald, McClatchy Media (Tri-Cities, WA)

Latino Communities Reporter | May 2026 - Oct 2026

- Covered Pasco city council, reporting on an increase in cannabis retail licenses, state regulations prompting the city to establish zoning rules for sex offender housing and tensions between city leaders and Republican county officials over access to softball fields used by local Latino soccer leagues.
- Reported on how changes to Washington's voting rights laws could strengthen Latino political representation in Pasco, a majority-Hispanic city, exploring the community's fight for a greater voice in local government.
- Interviewed two Mexican immigrant women in the Tri-Cities who each paid at least $15,000 to immigration attorney Alexandra Lozano, accused of defrauding clients. Earned their trust to obtain supporting documents and corroborate their allegations, documenting the financial and emotional toll on their families.
- Profiled two Latina TikTok creators using social media to build community among residents in the Tri-Cities, preserve cultural traditions and inform Spanish-speaking audiences about their voting rights.

Freelance Reporter - Documented NY, El País US, Palabra NAHJ

New York, NY | Sep 2024 - May 2026

- Followed Harlem volunteers as they visited immigrant-owned businesses to distribute know-your-rights materials amid heightened ICE enforcement, interviewing organizers and business owners about their efforts to prepare immigrant communities for potential encounters with federal agents.
- Interviewed Spanish-speaking asylum seekers and immigration advocates to investigate gaps in New York City's publicly funded legal services, documenting how delays and limited access to representation affected immigrants navigating the asylum process.
- Reported on Venezuelan immigrants in New York City responding to Nicolás Maduro's capture, gathering firsthand accounts of their conflicting hopes, fears and concerns about Venezuela's future.
- Profiled a Peruvian fashion designer challenging conventional runway representation by featuring transgender migrants and exploring the intersection of fashion, identity and immigration.
- Created a Datawrapper visualization to illustrate changes in the length of time unaccompanied minors remained in federal custody, connecting government data to the experiences documented in the reporting.

WNYC/Gothamist (New York, NY)

Reporter Intern | Oct – Dec 2025

- Pitched and reported on eviction notices issued to migrant families at Manhattan's Row Hotel shelter, leveraging sources developed through previous reporting to interview affected residents about the impact of New York City's shelter policies.
- Reported on access to public benefits in New York City, translating complex eligibility requirements into accessible service journalism.
- Adapted reporting and interviews into radio scripts, working with editors and producers to prepare stories for broadcast audiences.

The Arizona Republic / USA Today Co. (Phoenix, AZ)

Reporter intern | Jun – Aug 2025

- Reported 12 stories in English and Spanish for the National Desk and La Voz, including a story about how federal cuts to legal representation affected unaccompanied immigrant children and their ability to navigate immigration proceedings.
- Obtained and analyzed a nonpublic dataset from an Arizona nonprofit to examine migration trends and the recovery of migrant remains along the U.S.–Mexico border.